

Chapter 55-1

The name Gina left no impression on Liang Shi whatsoever.

But Zhao Xuning's expression didn't seem fake.

So her first reaction was that the original owner had once gone to see a psychologist.

Liang Shi pressed her lips together, remaining silent for a moment before saying, "And then?"

Zhao Xuning raised an eyebrow, her cold and indifferent face showing a few traces of inscrutability: "Nothing then, we just chatted for a bit."

"Related to me?" Liang Shi asked.

Zhao Xuning looked straight at her, "What do you think?"

The two went back and forth, neither giving a definitive answer.

Question against question in a battle to see whose psychological defenses would crumble first.

Continuing like this, they definitely wouldn't get any effective information.

But Liang Shi knew that to extract information from someone like Zhao Xuning, she had to first give her enough information.

Especially since this was for her own sake.

Every piece of information related to the original owner was very important now.

The original owner was unwilling to share those painful memories, and she couldn't possibly rely on stumbling upon key objects by chance to trigger all memories, so starting from the real world was the fastest approach.

As long as things had happened, they would inevitably leave traces.

Liang Shi's mind went through a storm. She pressed her temples and let out a light sigh.

She made eye contact with Zhao Xuning.

During rest time, Zhao Xuning wore plain glasses, which softened her sharp edges somewhat, making her look like a lake that could reflect all of one's thoughts.

She sat there with elegant posture, her expression calm. When she met Liang Shi's gaze, she was neither arrogant nor impatient.

After a long while, Liang Shi lowered her voice and asked, "Can I trust you?"

Zhao Xuning didn't answer directly. She gently rotated the ceramic cup in her hand, lifted it to take a sip of coffee, then used her fingertip to wipe away the lipstick mark on the cup rim. Her thin lips parted slightly, "Don't use those you suspect; don't suspect those you use."

Liang Shi suddenly laughed. She leaned back in her chair, and after laughing enough, she sat up straight, reached for her coat from the side, tilted her head toward Zhao Xuning, and invited in a relaxed tone, "Let's go, Dr. Zhao. We'll talk in the car."

Originally, Zhao Xuning was going to go to her car with Liang Shi, but when they got outside, Liang Shi directly handed over the initiative, "Let's go to your car."

Zhao Xuning frowned but quickly relaxed.

Understanding her intention, she smiled knowingly, "Alright."

Zhao Xuning's car was parked by the roadside with privacy film—you could see outside from inside, but not inside from outside.

The privacy was very good.

This was during peak hours, and two beautiful women with excellent figures walking together had nearly a 100% head-turning rate.

But both Liang Shi and Zhao Xuning ignored the passersby's gazes.

After getting in the car, Liang Shi spoke first, "I, or rather Liang Shi, have self-harmed before."

She laid out her cards to Zhao Xuning.

Upon hearing this, Zhao Xuning raised an eyebrow, but her first concern wasn't about the self-harm, but about the first half of the sentence, "You, or Liang Shi? Then who exactly are you?"

"My name is Liang Shi," Liang Shi said. "But I'm not the original Liang Shi. During that hospital incident, I truly did have memory loss. I don't remember many things about that person, but recently I've gradually regained some memories. I originally lived in another world and had another identity."

Zhao Xuning looked at her and after a moment asked very seriously, "Have you been examined by psychiatry?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She said helplessly, "Didn't you say don't suspect those you use?"

"But I reasonably suspect this is a form of split personality," Zhao Xuning approached from a medical perspective. "Some people, under great real-world pressure, fantasize about a different past and believe they are someone else."

"I can clearly state that it's not," Liang Shi said. "I don't know what happened to bring me here to become another Liang Shi, but during the process of memory recovery, I discovered many things, so I want to ask for your help."

This was also Liang Shi's purpose in laying her cards on the table.

Even as calm and rational as she was, Zhao Xuning had a moment of questioning reality upon hearing this. She looked at Liang Shi: "Then why are you telling me this? If I called a research institute right now, you'd be taken away for experiments."

Liang Shi smiled gently, revealing her least harmful yet sharpest weapon, and answered firmly, "You won't."

Zhao Xuning: "..."

She raised an eyebrow with a hint of wickedness, "How do you know I won't?"

As if trying to undermine Liang Shi's confidence, she sneered coldly, "Liang Shi, don't forget, I also grew up in scheming and intrigue. You think too highly of my kindness."

"It's not that I think highly of your kindness," Liang Shi said. "You are inherently kind."

She paused and added, "Or perhaps I should say you're a person of integrity."

Zhao Xuning: "Hmm?"

"You never show blind kindness. After Bai Weiwei was in danger, you could use every method to save her, but after she didn't understand you, you decisively gave up on that friendship. You're very rational," Liang Shi said. "You might have evil thoughts, but you would never act on them because you're a person of integrity. Your moral baseline is higher than most people's. Even if you don't like me, you wouldn't backstab me, because when I entrust my trust to you, you feel a sense of responsibility."

The car fell into a long silence.

Then Liang Shi smiled warmly and said, "This is why I trust you. Besides, we're friends now, aren't we? If I can't even trust you, I don't know who else I can trust here."

Zhao Xuning: "Nonsense."

Liang Shi: "There's also Xu Qingzhu."

Both spoke almost simultaneously.

Then they looked at each other and laughed.